



THE SAVE AMERICA ACT

Safeguard American Voter Eligibility Act

H.R. 7296 / S. 1383 — 119th Congress of the United States

A plain-language guide to the bill's actual text and status

Prepared September 2026 • Not yet enacted into law

What This Bill Does

The SAVE America Act — formally the **Safeguard American Voter Eligibility Act** — is federal legislation that would change the requirements for registering to vote in U.S. federal elections. It was introduced in the House as H.R. 7296 by Rep. Chip Roy (R-TX) on January 30, 2026, and a related measure has moved in the Senate as S. 1383. The House passed a version of the bill on February 11, 2026, largely along party lines; as of this writing it has not passed the Senate and has not been signed into law.

Core Provisions

- Requires applicants to present **documentary proof of U.S. citizenship** in person before a state may accept or process a federal voter registration application.
- Defines acceptable documentary proof, including a REAL ID-compliant document indicating citizenship, a U.S. passport, military ID with service record showing U.S. birth, or a government-issued photo ID paired with a certified birth certificate or other qualifying citizenship record.
- Directs states to establish a program — using free access to DHS and Social Security Administration databases — to identify and remove non-citizens already on the voter rolls.
- Creates a limited "safe harbor" for states that have queried DHS's SAVE database quarterly since June 1, 2025 to check registrants' citizenship status.
- Expands the National Voter Registration Act's private right of action so citizens can bring civil suits against election officials who fail to enforce the proof-of-citizenship requirement, and adds penalties for officials who knowingly register non-citizens.
- Directs the Election Assistance Commission to update related federal guidance and exempts those updates from standard Paperwork Reduction Act review.
- Requires states to provide reasonable accommodations for applicants with disabilities or documentation discrepancies caused by a legal name change.

Note: earlier claims that the bill bans mail-in ballots or contains provisions on school sports or medical procedures are not accurate — the introduced and House-passed text does not include those provisions.

Legislative Snapshot

Item	Detail
Short title	Safeguard American Voter Eligibility Act ("SAVE America Act")
Bill numbers	H.R. 7296 (House) / S. 1383 (Senate)
Congress	119th Congress (2025–2026)
Sponsor	Rep. Chip Roy (R-TX-21), House Administration Committee
Introduced	January 30, 2026
House passage	February 11, 2026 — record vote 216–215
Senate status	Pending; has not reached the 60-vote threshold to clear the filibuster
Signed into law?	No — not enacted as of September 2026

Where the Debate Stands

Supporters, including the bill's House sponsors and President Trump, argue the measure closes a gap in federal election security by verifying citizenship at registration. Opponents — including the League of Women Voters and the Campaign Legal Center — argue the documentary-proof requirement would make registration harder for eligible voters who lack easy access to a passport or certified birth certificate, particularly women who have changed their name, older Americans, rural residents, and people with disabilities. Congressional Republicans have also tried moving related provisions through must-pass vehicles such as the FY2027 National Defense Authorization Act, which supporters call a practical path to passage and critics call a procedural workaround.

Read the Official Text

This document is a plain-language overview, not a substitute for the bill itself. The official, authoritative text — including the full legal amendments to the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 — is available free from the Library of Congress at [congress.gov/bill/119th-congress/house-bill/7296](https://www.congress.gov/bill/119th-congress/house-bill/7296) and from the House Rules Committee for the amended Senate version, S. 1383.

This overview was compiled from public congressional records (Congress.gov, GovTrack, House Rules Committee) and nonpartisan and advocacy sources for informational purposes. Legislative status can change quickly — confirm the current status before sharing or acting on this information.